Default params & null

Why greet(null) prints null

default.js

```
1 function greet(name = "Guest") {
2   console.log(name);
3 }
4 greet(); // "Guest"
5 greet(undefined); // "Guest"
6 greet(null); // null
```

output "Guest" "Guest" null

Why it happens

01 Only undefined
Defaults kick in only when the value is undefined.

02 Missing = undefined
Calling greet() passes undefined, so you get Guest.

03 null is a real value
You passed it on purpose, so JavaScript keeps it.

04 Fix with ??
name ?? "Guest" covers both null and undefined.

?? vs ||

Pick the right fallback

value	name ?? "Guest"	name || "Guest"
undefined	"Guest"	"Guest"
null	"Guest"	"Guest"
""	""	"Guest"
0	0	"Guest"
false	false	"Guest"

Traps to mention

- **|| replaces every falsy value,** so 0 and "" get lost. Use ?? for real defaults.
- **Defaults run at call time,** so (a = Date.now()) is fresh on every call.
- **Destructuring defaults** follow the same rule: only undefined triggers them.

Your 20-second answer

"Default parameters only apply when the argument is undefined. Passing nothing gives undefined, so the default is used, but null is a real value, so it is kept. If I want a fallback for both, I use the nullish operator, name ?? 'Guest', instead of ||, which would also replace 0 and empty strings.